



Trauma and Abuse Stories during the Interview

Here are some very basic guidelines on how to deal with clients who reveal trauma and abuse situations during the interview. Above all, remember that you are in charge of this session and your client has come to you for assistance, so you must maintain a neutral, professional, warm and understanding demeanor, without displaying extreme emotions or reactions yourself.

You will hear terrible, sometimes unspeakable things, but you must not visibly react in horror. You can hold compassion in your eyes without needing to react with extreme emotion. Some of you who are just starting out may not know exactly what to say. So, we have provided a few small scenarios below to illustrate possible responses to help you feel more confident when this situation arises.

Remember that their own inner wisdom and guidance will come forth in the session to provide deeper responses and revelations about trauma, it is not your job to eliminate any grief or anger they may have, nor to provide any specific advice. That is the Higher Self's job. You don't even have to say a lot or a great many words when these stories are related because it's just not necessary. As matter of fact, the more nodding you do – and just connecting to them with your eyes and your open and understanding heart, the better. Do NOT feel like you have to “fill up” any silence with words.

Client says: “I had a very hard childhood, my grandfather abused me every Sunday after church. I tried to tell my mother, but she never believed me and I was punished for making up stories. My grandfather didn't stop until I was a teenager, I left school and home because I couldn't handle being around him. Today I don't have any contact with my family because they still don't believe me and it's too painful seeing my grandfather viewed as beloved when I know he's a monster”.

You can say: “That must have been very hard not to be believed.” Or “It must be painful to be separated from your family like that”.

Client says: “I lost my oldest child to suicide...I never even knew he was in pain. It's taken years for me to finally be functional again, but I still feel like his death is my fault somehow”.

You can say: “One of the hardest things for any human to face is the death of a child. That must have been devastating”.



Client says: *"My father abandoned my family when I was 7. My mother became an alcoholic to cope. My siblings and I were removed from her care when I was 12 and moved from foster home to foster home. I've never felt loved and that affects everything in my life".*

You can say: "That must have been hard to grow up so early and surrounded by so much pain".

Client says: *"I'm being stalked by my abusive husband. I spend every minute of my life looking over my shoulder and being afraid".*

You can say: "That must be a very hard way to live day to day"

Client says, *"I lost my legs in the war. I need help doing everything and I just hate being so weak".*

You can say: "I understand. It must hard to have to depend on others that way".

This sort of thing gets easier over time and you can always consider taking a course in counseling to assist you with skills if you desire. The important thing is to 'be there' for your client without overstepping and remember your job is to facilitate alignment with your client and their higher self, so that they can do the healing.